THE NEXT 100
INHERITORS

Finding His Groove

ANANT GOENKA, 40

Managing Director, CEAT, **Mumbai**

"What drives me is the challenge of making a larger impact on our customers and on society than anyone else, with limited resources"

Before taking over the mantle at tyremaker CEAT when he was just 30, Anant Goenka cut his teeth at KEC International, an RPG Group firm that makes transmission towers, where he oversaw operations in supply chain management, manufacturing, planning and quality control. Under his leadership, CEAT saw its net sales grow from Rs 4,649 crore in 2011-12 to Rs 7,573 crore in 2020-21. Goenka's focus has been on high-margin products, bringing about rapid innovation and marketing aggressively. He changed the product mix at the company, prioritising sales of high-margin two-wheeler and SUV tyres over the low-margin crossply tyres used in commercial vehicles.



MANDAR DEODHAR

With an MBA from the Kellogg School of Management and a BS (Economics) from the Wharton School at the University of Pennsylvania, Goenka led CEAT to win the Deming Prize in 2017, one of the world's most prestigious awards in quality management. Before joining CEAT, he had worked with Hindustan Unilever, Accenture and Morgan Stanley. The son of industrialist Harsh Goenka and Mala Goenka he is also a member of the management board at RPG Enterprises. ■

–M.G. Arun

WORK HARD, PLAY HARD

A fitness freak, Goenka enjoys running and likes to play squash on weekends. He also enjoys Japanese food.